THE NEXT HAND · NOTES

How the Best Innovate

Creativity & Design Thinking · SFIMAR, St. Francis, Borivali · 17 Oct 2026 · Nishit Kamath

INNOHATCH
TO 27 NOV 2026

You can't choose your hand. Only your next move. Innovation isn't luck or genius: it's a process you can copy, and test this week.

Four suits every company plays

THE SAME FOUR QUESTIONS, SO YOU CAN COMPARE

- ♠ Where ideas start
- ♥ How they understand people
- ♦ How they test
- ♣ How they scale

Six companies, six practices to steal

AND THE MYTH EACH ONE BUSTS

COMPANY	HOW THEY PLAY	STEAL THIS, THIS WEEK	MYTH CHECK
IDEO	Design around people. Prototype early, and rough.	**30 ideas in 20 minutes, using the 7 brainstorm rules.**	✕ IDEO didn't design Apple's first mouse: its forerunner Hovey-Kelley did (1980–81).
Apple	Say no to almost everything, then obsess over what's left.	**One owner (DRI) for every task, and a "not doing" list.**	✕ Apple does research its buyers: court filings (2012) showed regular surveys.
Samsung	Change everything. Then make quality and design everyone's job.	**Take a rival product apart as a mixed team; list 10 insights on value and cost.**	✕ It wasn't only quality: design was central too (SADI 1995, Design Revolution 1996).
3M	Give people time and tolerance, and let ideas find each other.	**90 minutes a week on your own experiment; show it in 3 minutes.**	✕ Post-it wasn't luck: glue (1968) + bookmark idea (1974) + years of championing.
Google	Set big goals, test small and fast, and make it safe to speak up.	**A one-day sprint: map, sketch, vote, paper prototype, test with 5 people.**	✕ Gmail wasn't 20% time: it was an assigned project. News and AdSense were.
VNV Printlab	Model before mould: find the friction, talk to the people affected.	**Show a sketch or model to 3 customers before you build anything.**	Our own studio: no R&D budget, Silver + Best of Nation at WorldSkills Shanghai 2026 (Bakery).

IDEO's 7 rules of brainstorming

PIN THEM UP BEFORE YOU START

1. **Defer judgment**
2. **Encourage wild ideas**
3. **Build on the ideas of others**
4. **Stay focused on the topic**
5. **One conversation at a time**
6. **Be visual**
7. **Go for quantity**

Why the myth checks?

Famous stories make innovation sound like luck or genius. The real story is almost always a process: people, prototypes, tests and time. And checking a famous "fact" is the same habit you need when you use AI.

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My toolkit: the 6C process and four tools USE THEM ON YOUR INNOHATCH IDEA

6C — MY PROCESS

Face a concern → find a cause → compare research → conceive the idea → convince it can exist → continue. At every step: **communicate with the people affected.**

AEIOU — OBSERVE

Activity · **E**nvironment · **I**nteraction · **O**bject · **U**ser. Watch all five before you decide what the problem is.

Task analysis — BREAK IT DOWN

List every step of something ordinary (like making ginger tea). Each step is a place it can go wrong, and a place for a better product.

5 E's — MAP THE JOURNEY

Entice (what catches attention) → **Enter** (how they begin) → **Engage** (how they use it) → **Exit** (how it ends) → **Extend** (why they come back). Where do your customers drop off?

L.I.F.E — TEST FOR DIGNITY

Does your idea respect what your customer values: their **Love, Identity, Freedom and Expression**?

Ask your team — TONIGHT

At which E does our customer drop off? Which step of their task is slowest or messiest? Does our idea respect their dignity?

Using AI well A TEAMMATE, NOT A SEARCH ENGINE

1. **Give it your situation** · Who you are, who the customer is, budget, deadline.
2. **Make it ask first** · "Ask me 5 questions, one at a time, before you answer."
3. **Make it argue** · "Play a sceptical customer. Push back on my price."
4. **Make it build the test** · "Write a 6-question survey and a poster for this."
5. **Check it with a person** · AI can be confidently wrong. Every claim gets one real-world check.

The Experiment Card ONE CHEAP TEST, THIS WEEK

S **Scenario** · Who is your customer, where and when? One thing you saw them do.

C **Challenge** · [Customer] needs [need] because [insight].

O **Opportunity** · Your idea in one line + the company move you're stealing.

R **Resolution** · The cheapest test you can make in 48 hours.

E **Expansion** · Test with how many people? What counts as success? First-sale target.

Road to 27 Nov SIX WEEKS, ONE PROOF A WEEK

- **17–23 Oct** — Run the experiment
- **24–30 Oct** — Change one thing
- **31 Oct–6 Nov** — First sale
- **7–20 Nov** — Sell + log
- **21–26 Nov** — Rehearse 5–7 min
- **27 Nov** — Present: evidence, not adjectives

Your next move PLAY IT THIS WEEK

1 · Steal one practice

From IDEO, Apple, Samsung, 3M, Google or VNV (page 1).

2 · Run one experiment

Your Experiment Card, before next Saturday.

3 · Make one sale

Before 6 Nov, so you have proof on 27 Nov.

Log your proof weekly
live.thenexthand.com/sfimar

MY NOTES · THE ONE THING I'LL TRY THIS WEEK